Guidelines for Annotating Synthetic Patient–Agent Dialogues with SPO Labels

Prepared for LREC 2026 submission (anonymous version)

The Task

The primary goal of this annotation task is to extract structured semantic relationships in the form of Subject-Predicate-Object (SPO) triples from synthetic conversations between a Type 2 Diabetes patient and an agent. This process is essential for building a comprehensive set of data to assess the performance of a Conversational Triple Extractor (CTE). The triples generated by the CTE are designed to be integrated into the knowledge graph of The Project (REMOVED_FOR_ANONYMOUS_REVIEW), enhancing its utility.

The Process

For this task, the **INCEpTION** annotation tool will be utilized, a cutting-edge platform specifically designed for annotation tasks (see *Figure 1*). You will leverage this tool to ensure high-quality and precise annotations.

To install and run the tool on your system, please follow the INCEpTION User Guide.

After successfully installing the tool, you will receive a unique '***Username***' and '***Password***' to log in. Additionally, you will receive the project file, which you need to import it by clicking the "***Import Project***" button on the tool's main page. These credentials are necessary to access and participate in the project on the platform.

Following this, you are required to follow the instructions outlined below for annotating each conversation.

After annotating the conversations, please export the annotated data by clicking the "***Export document***" button, and by choosing the "***WebAnno TSV v3.3 (WebAnno v3.x)***" format.

Finally, please send the annotated data to the project creator.

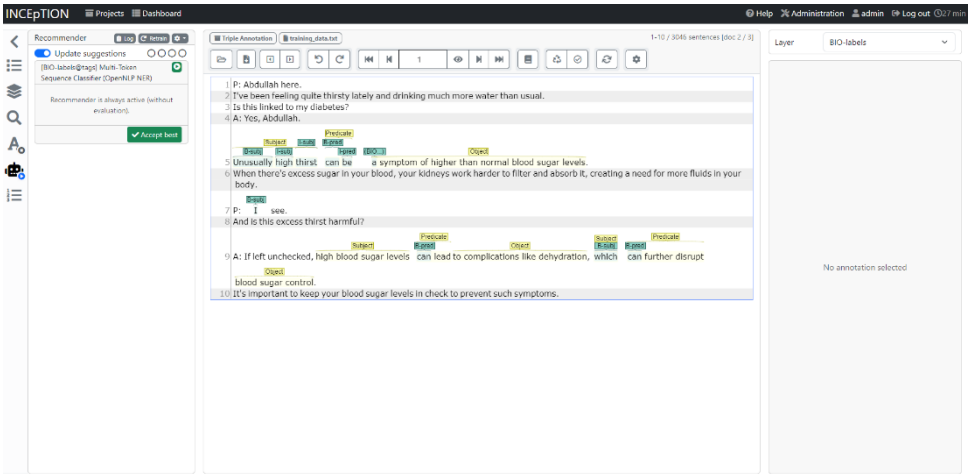


Figure 1: INCEpTION Annotation Tool Interface

Instructions

NOTE: You don't have to annotate each sentence, only the ones you think contain important information about diabetes management that can be stored into the knowledge graph. We are interested in the information contained within a conversation and not how the conversation flows.

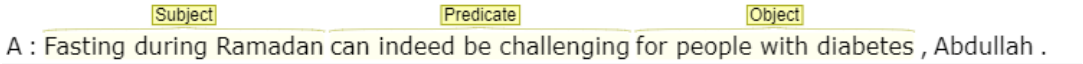
1. Identify the **Subject** in each sentence. It can be found by first locating the main verb/verb phrase, then determining "who" or "what" is performing the action described by the verb/verb phrase. Include any determiner that is part of the Subject.

2. Locate the main verb/verb phrase to identify the **Predicate**, which expresses the action, occurrence, or state of being of the Subject. Include any auxiliary verbs, modifiers, and adverbs that are part of the Predicate.

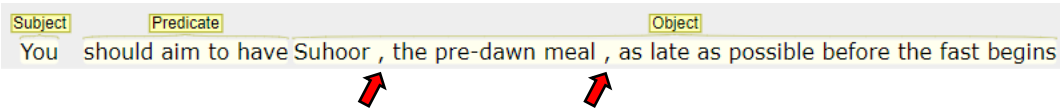
3. Identify and annotate the **Object** in each sentence by determining "what" or "whom" is directly receiving the action, or "to whom", "for whom", "to what" and "for what" the action affects. Include any determiner that is part of the Object.

   i.e. in " *The doctor accurately adjusted the insulin dosage .* ", the extracted triple should be (Subject: "*The doctor*", Predicate: "*accurately adjusted*", Object: "*the insulin dosage*").

4. **Exclude** all punctuation marks from your annotations, except in instances where punctuations (like commas) are integral to the continuity of the sentence being annotated. In such cases, include the punctuation within the annotation.
   i.e. a case where you should exclude all the punctuation marks from your annotations:

   i.e. a case where you should keep some of the punctuation marks in your annotations:

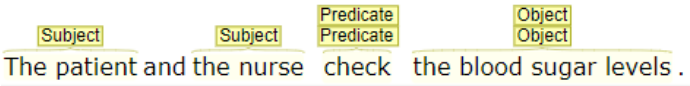
   

Special Cases

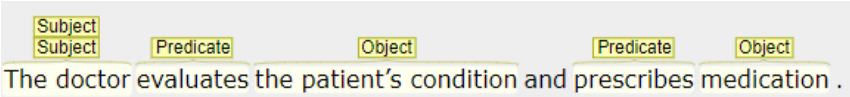
1. In passive voice sentences, the Subject is the receiver of the action, but you should still label it as the Subject.
   i.e. in " *Medication is prescribed to the patient by the doctor .* ", the extracted triple should be (Subject: "*the patient*", Predicate: "*is prescribed*", Object: "*medication*").

2. Annotate entire subordinate clauses that function as Subjects or Objects.
   i.e. in "*What the patient reported about their glucose levels concerned the doctor*", annotate "*What the patient reported about their glucose levels*" as Subject.

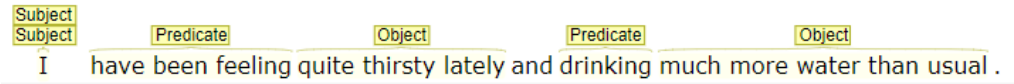
3. Annotate each component of compound Subjects or Predicates separately.
   i.e. in " *The patient and the nurse check the blood sugar levels .* ", annotate "*the patient*" and "*the nurse*" as **Subjects** separately. Then annotate twice *"check"* as **Predicate** and twice *"the blood sugar levels"* as **Object**. In that way you distinguish the two triples.



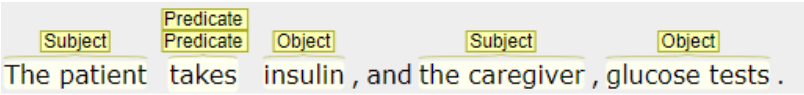
   Likewise, when a single **Subject** performs multiple actions, such as in "*The doctor evaluates the patient's condition and prescribes medication*", mark "*evaluates*" and "*prescribes*" as **Predicates** separately, and annotate twice *"The doctor"* as **Subject**.



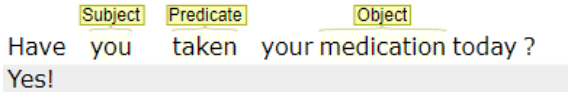
4. In cases where the Subject or the Predicate are implied, annotate the explicit Subject or Predicate twice.
   i.e. when the **Subject** is implied:



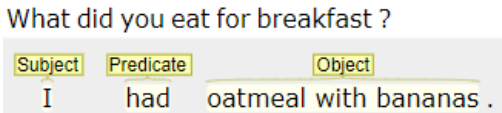
   i.e. when the **Predicate** is implied:



5. In cases where one utterance poses a question and the next provides its corresponding answer, follow the instructions below:
   1. If we have a **closed question** (simply "Yes/No" answer), extract the triple only from the question.
      i.e. in *"Have you taken your medication today?"*, and the answer is simply *"Yes"*, the extracted triple should be (**Subject**: *"You"*, **Predicate**: *"taken"*, **Object**: *"medication"*). Same if the answer was simply *"No"*.

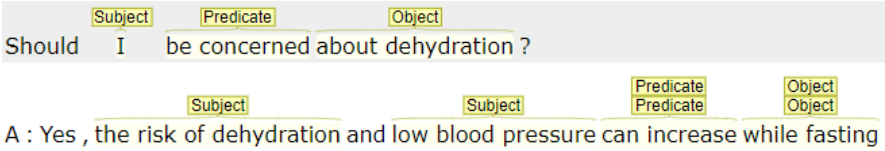


   2. If we have an **open question** (detailed answer), extract the triple only from the answer.
      i.e. in *"What did you eat for breakfast?"*, and the answer is *"I had oatmeal with bananas"*, the extracted triple should be (**Subject**: *"I"*, **Predicate**: *"had"*, **Object**: *"oatmeal with bananas"*).



   3. If the response includes **both a "Yes/No" component and additional information**, please annotate both the question and the answer accordingly.

i.e. in "*Should I be concerned about dehydration?*", and the answer is "*Yes, the risk of dehydration and low blood pressure can increase while fasting.*", the extracted triple from the question should be (**Subject**: "*I*", **Predicate**: "*be concerned*", **Object**: "*about dehydration*"), and the two extracted triples from the answer should be (**Subject**: "*the risk of dehydration*", **Predicate**: "*can increase*", **Object**: "*while fasting*") and (**Subject**: "*low blood pressure*", **Predicate**: "*can increase*", **Object**: "*while fasting*").



Acknowledgment

We sincerely thank all annotators for their careful contributions and commitment to ensuring the accuracy and quality of this dataset. Your efforts have been instrumental in developing a resource that will advance research on medical dialogue understanding.